What it costs, and whether video is affordable

Measured against the live systems on 1 September 2026, not estimated.

> **Update, 26 October 2026.** The bill below left out tax. The latest invoice was **$38.47**: the Pro plan ($25), compute for the second project ($9.35), and tax of $4.12 (12% of the two). At about ₱61 to the dollar that is about **₱2,350 a month**. The plan is per organisation, and each church runs its own project, because one shared project would make the hubs one company's service, not each church's own. To meet the monthly cost, a church can now choose to ask its members: the giving room, optional and off until switched on, shows the month's goal and how to give, and never who gave (HANDBOOK.md (https://github.com/klydo131/open-sentry-beacon/blob/main/docs/HANDBOOK.md), "Keep our Hope Hub running").

Two things turned up while costing this, and both change the answer.

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1. This app is not on a free plan, and every document said it was

The Supabase organisation **Local Church** is on the **Pro** plan. The handbook says "the app will run a church of a hundred on a free plan"; the pivot plan is built around "$0/month, honestly" and lists Supabase Pro as a *future* trigger. Both are wrong, and they have been wrong while decisions were made on them, including the advice I gave yesterday that video "would end this church's free plan".

There are also **two projects** on that organisation, not one:

Project	Created	Size	Accounts	Last sign-in
Open-Sentry-Beacon	12 Aug 2026	16 MB	63	live, today
Local Church App Project	20 Jul 2026	14 MB	9	26 Aug 2026

The second is the predecessor with nine accounts on it. Supabase charges per project beyond the plan's included compute, and the API reports **$10/month** for an additional project.

So the bill today

	Monthly
Supabase Pro, organisation	$25
Second project, still running	$10
Total, confirmed	**$35**
Vercel	**not known — see §5**
Brevo	$0 on the free tier
GitHub Actions	$0, unmetered on a public repository

At roughly ₱58 to the dollar, **$35 is about ₱2,030 a month**, against a stated budget of **₱2,000**.

> **You are a fraction over budget, and the whole of the overage is a project nobody uses.** Pausing *Local Church App Project* takes it to $25, about **₱1,450**, which is comfortably inside. Its data is kept while paused.
>
> I have not paused it. It holds a client's data and turning it off is not mine to decide.

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2. What is actually being used

The church has been live for **sixteen days**.

	Now	Pro includes	Used
Database	16 MB	8 GB	0.2%
Files	34 MB	100 GB	0.03%
Accounts	63	100,000 monthly	negligible

People: **63 members, 29 Guides, 26 Explorers, 24 active pairings.** Twenty-nine Guides at five each is capacity for 145 Explorers, so the app is at about a sixth of what its people can carry.

Four Explorers have no Guide. That is the only number on this page that is about somebody being ignored rather than about money.

The rate it is growing at

Measured over the last seven days: **15 files, 27 MB, averaging 2.14 MB each**, and 31 messages. Every one of those files is a photograph.

Photos, at the current rate	Per month	100 GB reached in
As they were, unshrunk	~117 MB	~71 years
Shrunk, as they are since yesterday	~21 MB	~400 years

Storage is not a constraint and was never going to be. I said yesterday that shrinking photos was mostly a cost fix; on the Pro plan that was wrong. It is worth keeping for two other reasons that stand on their own: it removes the GPS coordinates a phone writes into every picture, and it cuts the traffic each photo costs *every time somebody opens the thread*, which is the meter that actually moves.

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3. The video question, costed

A minute of phone video is roughly **80 MB** at 1080p and about half that at 720p. A photograph, after shrinking, is about **0.2 MB**. One minute of video is therefore about **four hundred photographs**.

Storage: not the problem

If the church sent	Per month	100 GB reached in
1 video a week	~350 MB	~24 years
5 videos a week	~1.7 GB	~5 years

Traffic: the meter that matters, and it still holds

Every view of a private file is a fresh download; no cache keeps them. Pro includes **250 GB a month**.

If the church sent	Watched by 20 people each	Share of the 250 GB
1 video a week	~6 GB/month	3%
5 videos a week	~35 GB/month	14%
20 videos a week	~139 GB/month	55%

At this church's size, video is affordable. That is the honest answer and it is not the one I gave yesterday. Twenty videos a week from sixty-three people would be unusual, and even that sits inside the plan.

Where it stops being affordable

Many churches on one instance, which is the plan. Ten churches behaving like this one, at five videos a week each, is about **350 GB a month** — past the 250 GB allowance and into per-gigabyte charges. Video is the one thing in this app whose cost grows with *both* the number of churches and how much each one uses it.

Three reasons that are not about money

Costing was asked for, so these are separate and they are for the owner to weigh, not for me:

1. **Safeguarding.** A conversation attachment has no moderation queue. A photograph of a minor is already a serious thing to hold; a video of one is a different order of risk, and this app has children in it with guardian consent recorded against their names.
2. **The member pays for it too.** Eighty megabytes on mobile data is a real cost to somebody in a congregation, and they have no way to know how big the thing is before it downloads. This app is built for cheap phones on metered connections.
3. **It may simply not play.** An iPhone records HEVC by default. Chrome on Android often will not play it, so an Explorer could be sent a video they cannot open, with nothing on screen to explain why.

What I would do

Allow it, with a short limit, and measure before widening it. A 25 MB cap takes about twenty seconds of 1080p or a minute of 720p, which is enough for "here is the passage I meant" and not enough to be a habit. Keep the YouTube link as the answer for anything longer. Then look at the traffic after a month before deciding anything else.

That is a change to the bucket's allowlist, the picker, and one line of copy. It is small. **I have not made it** — you asked for the cost first, and the decision is yours.

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4. What the money buys as churches join

The Pro plan is per organisation, not per church, and the app is already multi-tenant. So the bill does not multiply.

Churches on one instance	Cost each, at $25/month
1	₱1,450
5	₱290
10	₱145

Never one project per church. Ten separate Pro projects is ten times $10 in compute on top of the plan, for the same work.

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5. What I cannot see, and will not guess

- **The Vercel account that serves the site.** The one this session can reach is `klydo131's projects`, on the free Hobby plan, and it has **no projects in it**. The live site is deployed from an account I have no access to. If it is Hobby, it is free and the totals above stand. If it is Pro, add **$20/month** (about ₱1,160), which would put the bill over budget again even with the old project paused.
- **The actual invoice.** The $25 and $10 are the published plan price and the figure Supabase's own API reports for an added project. The billing page is the only thing that can confirm what is really charged.
- **Per-gigabyte overage rates.** This sandbox cannot reach Supabase's pricing page. The allowances above are what matters at today's volumes; the overage rates matter only in the ten-church case and should be read off the pricing page before that decision.

- **The domain.** Yours is not pointed at anything yet, and I do not know what it renews at.
- **Development cost.** Your time, and the assistants. Not something I can put a number on.

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6. The short version

- **You are on Pro, paying about $35 a month, which is roughly ₱2,030 against a ₱2,000 budget.** Every document in the repository said you were on a free plan. They have been corrected.
- **Pausing the old project takes you to about ₱1,450** and is the single cleanest saving available.
- **Storage will not be a problem this decade.** Traffic is the meter to watch.
- **Video is affordable at this size** and stops being affordable at about ten churches. If it goes in, it goes in with a short cap and gets measured.
- **Confirm the Vercel account.** It is the one number that could still put you over, and it has been unknown for the whole of this project.